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2026-05-06

Faith, Science, and Choice: Vaccine Attitudes among Religious University Students

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Jensen, Jamie, "Faith, Science, and Choice: Vaccine Attitudes among Religious University Students" (2026). *ScholarsArchive Data*. 102.
https://scholarsarchive.byu.edu/data/102

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Data Description- Faith, Science, and Choice: Vaccine Attitudes among Religious University Students.

These data come from a Q-methodology study examining vaccination attitudes among undergraduate students at Brigham Young University. Participants were recruited from an introductory non-majors biology course during the Fall 2025 semester. The study examined how students organized their views about vaccination across themes such as science, faith, family influence, government trust, public health responsibility, vaccine mandates, personal freedom, misinformation, and vaccine safety.

The Q-set included 37 vaccination-attitude statements. These statements were selected from a larger concourse of 240 statements drawn from published literature, public discourse, and interviews with BYU undergraduate students. Participants completed the Q-sort digitally using Qsortware. They first sorted statements into agree, disagree, and neutral categories. They then ranked all 37 statements on a forced distribution grid from −5 to +5, where −5 indicated strongest disagreement, +5 indicated strongest agreement, and 0 indicated uncertainty or neutrality.

“Q-sortware Exported_data(clean).xlsx”

This file contains the cleaned Qsortware export for the 30 Q-sorts used in the final analysis.

The file includes one sheet, labeled “exported_data-vaccination.”

Each row represents one participant Q-sort.

The first columns contain participant background information and post-sort comments:

Major: Participant's reported academic major.

Gender: Participant's reported gender.

Political Affiliation: Participant's reported political affiliation.

Religious Affiliation: Participant's reported religious affiliation.

Comments: Participant's written comment about the sorting activity.

The remaining columns, labeled Item 1 through Item 37, contain each participant's ranking for the 37 vaccination-attitude statements. Scores range from −5 to +5. Higher scores indicate stronger agreement with a statement, while lower scores indicate stronger disagreement. Each participant's rankings follow the forced Q-sort distribution used in the study.

"KenQ-Excel-T2-template-Vaccination.xlsx"

This file contains the Q-sort data formatted for analysis in Ken-Q.

The workbook includes several sheets:

"name"

This sheet gives the project name: "Vaccine attitudes."

"sorts"

This sheet contains the 30 participant Q-sorts in Ken-Q format. Each row represents one participant, labeled Subject 1 through Subject 30. The values across the row represent the participant's rankings of the 37 Q-set statements from −5 to +5.

“pattern”

This sheet gives the forced distribution pattern used in the Q-sort. The distribution includes two statements at −5, two at −4, three at −3, four at −2, five at −1, five at 0, five at +1, four at +2, three at +3, two at +4, and two at +5.

“statements”

This sheet lists the 37 vaccination-attitude statements used in the Q-sort. Each statement is numbered so the rankings in the “sorts” sheet match the statement list.

“version” and “type”

These sheets are part of the Ken-Q template and should not be changed or deleted.

The workbook also includes example sheets from the Ken-Q template. These are not part of the vaccination study data.

These files document the final analytic dataset used for the Q-methodology analysis. The Qsortware export preserves demographic information, participant comments, and statement-level rankings. The Ken-Q workbook contains the same Q-sort rankings in analysis-ready form, along with the Q-sort pattern and statement list needed to reproduce or review the Ken-Q analysis.

“Pre-sort Interview Transcripts”

The pre-sort interview files contain interviews conducted during the preliminary phase of the study. These interviews were used to gather student perspectives on vaccination before the final Q-set was developed. Interviewer questions can be found in the supplementary materials. The

stated purpose of these interviews was to identify perspectives and phrases that could inform later survey or Q-set development.

The uploaded pre-sort transcript files include raw and cleaned versions for five interviews:

“Transcript 1- Raw.docx”

“Transcript 1- Clean.docx”

“Transcript 2- Raw.docx”

“Transcript 2- Clean.docx”

“Transcript 3- Raw.docx”

“Transcript 3- Clean.docx”

“Transcript 4- Raw.docx”

“Transcript 4- Clean.docx”

“Transcript 5- Raw.docx”

“Transcript 5- Clean.docx”

The raw files is the original transcription format, including timestamps in some files. The cleaned files present corrected versions of the interview text.

“Post-sort Interview Transcripts”

The post-sort interview files contain follow-up interviews conducted after Q-sort analysis. These interviews were used to help interpret the factors and clarify why participants placed certain statements at high or low positions in the Q-sort.

The uploaded post-sort transcript files include clean and raw versions for two factor-based interviews:

“Factor 1-Clean.docx”

“Factor 1- Raw.vtt”

“Factor 3- Clean.docx”

“Factor 3- Raw.vtt”

The post-sort interview questions can be found in the supplementary materials as well. We did not get any students to interview for factor 2.